

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Environmental Institutions (MoEFCC, CPCB, NBA, WII) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Institution-type boundary?

A. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. B. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. C. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. D. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate.

Answer: A. Explanation: A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Institution-type boundary?

A. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. B. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. C. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. D. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.

Answer: B. Explanation: A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Institution-type boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. B. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. C. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. D. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.

Answer: C. Explanation: A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Institution-type boundary?

A. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. B. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. C. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. D. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.

Answer: D. Explanation: A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies MoEFCC ministry role?

A. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. B. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. C. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. D. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.

Answer: A. Explanation: MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of MoEFCC ministry role?

A. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. B. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. C. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. D. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.

Answer: B. Explanation: MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses MoEFCC ministry role without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. B. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. C. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. D. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.

Answer: C. Explanation: MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or

status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MoEFCC ministry role?

A. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. B. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. C. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. D. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.

Answer: D. Explanation: MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies CPCB statutory identity?

A. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. B. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. C. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. D. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.

Answer: A. Explanation: CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CPCB statutory identity?

A. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. B. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. C. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. D. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.

Answer: B. Explanation: CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses CPCB statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. B. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. C. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. D. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.

Answer: C. Explanation: CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CPCB statutory identity?

A. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. B. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. C. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. D. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.

Answer: D. Explanation: CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies CPCB national function?

A. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. B. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. C. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. D. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.

Answer: A. Explanation: CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CPCB national function?

A. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. B. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. C. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. D. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.

Answer: B. Explanation: CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses CPCB national function without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. B. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. C. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. D. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.

Answer: C. Explanation: CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CPCB national function?

A. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. B. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. C. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. D. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate.

Answer: D. Explanation: CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies SPCB consent-enforcement role?

A. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. B. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. C. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. D. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.

Answer: A. Explanation: SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of SPCB consent-enforcement role?

A. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. B. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. C. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. D. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.

Answer: B. Explanation: SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses SPCB consent-enforcement role without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. B. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. C. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. D. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.

Answer: C. Explanation: SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors,

institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about SPCB consent-enforcement role?

A. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. B. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. C. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. D. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.

Answer: D. Explanation: SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Standards-consent boundary?

A. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. B. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. C. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. D. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.

Answer: A. Explanation: National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Standards-consent boundary?

A. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. B. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. C. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. D. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.

Answer: B. Explanation: National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Standards-consent boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. B. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. C. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. D. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.

Answer: C. Explanation: National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Standards-consent boundary?

A. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. B. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. C. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. D. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.

Answer: D. Explanation: National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Central-state jurisdiction boundary?

A. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. B. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. C. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. D. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Central-state jurisdiction boundary?

A. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. B. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. C. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. D. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Central-state jurisdiction boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. B. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. C. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. D. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Central-state jurisdiction boundary?

A. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. B. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. C. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. D. Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies NBA statutory identity?

A. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. B. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. C. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. D. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NBA statutory identity?

A. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. B. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. C. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. D. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. The other

options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses NBA statutory identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. B. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. C. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. D. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NBA statutory identity?

A. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. B. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. C. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. D. The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies SBB role boundary?

A. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. B. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. C. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. D. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty.

Answer: A. Explanation: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of SBB role boundary?

A. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. B. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. C. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. D. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Answer: B. Explanation: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses SBB role boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. B. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. C. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. D. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence.

Answer: C. Explanation: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about SBB role boundary?

A. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. B. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. C. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. D. State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.

Answer: D. Explanation: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies BMC local role?

A. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. B. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. C. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. D. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Answer: A. Explanation: Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of BMC local role?

A. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. B. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. C. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. D. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence.

Answer: B. Explanation: Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses BMC local role without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. B. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. C. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. D. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.

Answer: C. Explanation: Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about BMC local role?

A. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. B. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. C. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. D. Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.

Answer: D. Explanation: Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies PBR evidence boundary?

A. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. B. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. C. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. D. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence.

Answer: A. Explanation: A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of PBR evidence boundary?

A. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. B. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. C. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. D. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.

Answer: B. Explanation: A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.

The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses PBR evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. B. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. C. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. D. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.

Answer: C. Explanation: A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PBR evidence boundary?

A. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. B. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. C. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. D. A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.

Answer: D. Explanation: A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies ABS boundary?

A. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. B. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. C. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. D. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.

Answer: A. Explanation: Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of ABS boundary?

A. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. B. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. C. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. D. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.

Answer: B. Explanation: Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses ABS boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. B. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. C. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. D. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about ABS boundary?

A. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. B. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. C. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. D. Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty.

Answer: D. Explanation: Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies WII institutional identity?

A. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. B. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. C. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. D. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of WII institutional identity?

A. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. B. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. C. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. D. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses WII institutional identity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. B. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. C. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. D. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WII institutional identity?

A. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. B. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. C. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. D. The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Science-regulation boundary?

A. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. B. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. C. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. D. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.

Answer: A. Explanation: WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science-regulation boundary?

A. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. B. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. C. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. D. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.

Answer: B. Explanation: WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Science-regulation boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. B. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. C. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. D. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage.

Answer: C. Explanation: WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science-regulation boundary?

A. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. B. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. C. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. D. WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence.

Answer: D. Explanation: WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Evidence-decision chain?

A. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. B. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. C. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. D. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.

Answer: A. Explanation: Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Evidence-decision chain?

A. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. B. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. C. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. D. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage.

Answer: B. Explanation: Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Evidence-decision chain without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. B. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. C. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. D. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages.

Answer: C. Explanation: Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Evidence-decision chain?

A. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. B. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. C. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. D. Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.

Answer: D. Explanation: Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies NTCA-WCCB boundary?

A. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. B. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. C. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. D. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NTCA-WCCB boundary?

A. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. B. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. C. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. D. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses NTCA-WCCB boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. B. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. C. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. D. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NTCA-WCCB boundary?

A. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. B. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. C. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. D. Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies NGT adjudication boundary?

A. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. B. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. C. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. D. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status

categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NGT adjudication boundary?

A. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. B. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. C. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. D. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses NGT adjudication boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. B. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. C. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. D. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NGT adjudication boundary?

A. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. B. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. C. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. D. The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Constituted-delegated boundary?

A. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. B. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. C. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. D. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.

Answer: A. Explanation: A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Constituted-delegated boundary?

A. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. B. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. C. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. D. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.

Answer: B. Explanation: A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Constituted-delegated boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. B. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. C. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. D. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.

Answer: C. Explanation: A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Constituted-delegated boundary?

A. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. B. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. C. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. D. A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.

Answer: D. Explanation: A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Coordination chain?

A. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. B. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. C. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. D. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Coordination chain?

A. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. B. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. C. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. D. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.

Answer: B. Explanation: Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Coordination chain without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. B. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. C. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. D. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate.

Answer: C. Explanation: Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Coordination chain?

A. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. B. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. C. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. D. Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage.

Answer: D. Explanation: Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Current evidence boundary?

A. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. B. A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. C. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. D. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.

Answer: A. Explanation: Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Current evidence boundary?

A. MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. B. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. C. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. D. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate.

Answer: B. Explanation: Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Current evidence boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. B. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. C. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. D. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. The other options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current evidence boundary?

A. CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. B. SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. C. National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. D. Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages.

Answer: D. Explanation: Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. The other

options belong to different media, parameters, processes, scales, actors, institutions, instruments or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED ENVIRONMENTAL-INSTITUTION, LEGAL-BASIS AND MANDATE PYQ OWNERSHIP

Audited ledgers route institution-matching and legal-basis concepts, including unkeyed or provisionally keyed objective demands. No objective answer, statutory power, mandate update or budget is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: correctly match each institution to its precise statutory basis and distinct functional mandate, avoiding conflation between similarly-named or similarly-themed bodies.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the multi-institution interaction around a single project (clearance, pollution consent, biodiversity access, litigation) is used to illustrate India's environmental-governance complexity.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	77	NIRANTAR environmental research platform, thematic verticals, and lead institutions	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026-■GS1-■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- NIRANTAR environmental research platform, thematic verticals, and lead institutions

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Prelims GS-I	98	Central Ground Water Authority districts overexploited legal basis	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Environmental specialist plus executive-versus-statutory classification Core; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	75	Body constituted under Environment Protection Act 1986	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Central Ground Water Authority districts overexploited legal basis
- Body constituted under Environment Protection Act 1986

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims questions matching institutions to their precise statutory basis and mandate

should be answered by applying each institution's specific founding Act and functional scope, avoiding conflation between similarly-themed bodies (e.g., WCCB versus NTCA).

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "strengthening India's environmental governance" should explicitly invoke the specialisation-versus-coordination-cost framework and the SPCB "last-mile" capacity critique as the central, cross-cutting analytical points.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a ministry, statutory regulator and research institute. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.
- MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.
- CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.
- The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish a ministry, statutory regulator and research institute. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish a ministry, statutory regulator and research institute. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish CPCB national functions from SPCB consent and enforcement. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.

Analysis: This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB national function. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.
- CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate.
- SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.
- National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.

- Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB national function. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish CPCB national functions from SPCB consent and enforcement. Answer in about 150...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB national function. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor

and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB national function. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB advises, coordinates State Boards, provides technical support, compiles data and lays down or modifies specified standards at national level within its legal mandate. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This

identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish CPCB national functions from SPCB consent and enforcement. Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the NBA-SBB-BMC biodiversity governance structure. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** PBR evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ABS boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system

boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.
- State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.
- Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.
- A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing.
- Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** PBR evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ABS boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the NBA-SBB-BMC biodiversity governance structure. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named**

evidence/example: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** PBR evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ABS boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance,

attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** PBR evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A People's Biodiversity Register is a local documentation instrument and knowledge record; its preparation does not itself grant access approval, determine ownership or prove benefit sharing. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ABS boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Access and Benefit Sharing links access to biological resources or associated knowledge with fair benefit arrangements under the applicable law; it is not a general wildlife-protection or pollution penalty. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the NBA-SBB-BMC biodiversity governance structure. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain how WII research informs but does not replace regulation. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-regulation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric

and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.
- WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence.
- Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.
- Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-regulation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how WII research informs but does not replace regulation. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the

source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-regulation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-regulation boundary. **Named evidence/example:** WII research can inform policy, management or adjudication, but evidence generation is distinct from granting consent, issuing a notification or enforcing an offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain how WII research informs but does not replace regulation. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Map India's environmental institutions by legal basis, scale and function. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary.

Named evidence/example: State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels.
- MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence.
- CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role.
- SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law.
- The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance.
- State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee.
- Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities.
- The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator.

- Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable.
- The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.
- A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; 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stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Map India's environmental institutions by legal basis, scale and function. Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBA statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** The National Biodiversity Authority is a statutory biodiversity body; its access and benefit-sharing role is not pollution control, wildlife-crime enforcement or environmental clearance. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SBB role boundary. **Named evidence/example:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** BMC local role. **Named evidence/example:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the

source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WII institutional identity. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NTCA-WCCB boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Tiger-conservation authority functions and wildlife-crime coordination are distinct from WII research and from CPCB pollution regulation; similar subject matter does not make mandates interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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6. **Claim and named evidence:** State Biodiversity Boards operate at the state level within the biodiversity governance framework; their role must not be transferred automatically to NBA or a local committee. **Analysis:**

Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

7. **Claim and named evidence:** Biodiversity Management Committees operate at the local-body level and support local biodiversity documentation and governance; they are not central licensing authorities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** The Wildlife Institute of India is a research, training and advisory institution in wildlife science and management; it is not a statutory environmental regulator. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
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10. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
11. **Claim and named evidence:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Institution-type boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A ministry, statutory board, statutory authority, notified authority, research institute, enforcement body and tribunal have different legal identities, outputs and accountability channels. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** MoEFCC ministry role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC is a Union ministry responsible for policy, administration and coordination across environment, forests and climate matters; it is not the field regulator for every consent or offence. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CPCB statutory identity. **Named evidence/example:** CPCB is a statutory pollution-control board under the water and air pollution-control framework; its national functions differ from a ministry's policy role. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** SPCB consent-enforcement role. **Named evidence/example:** SPCBs and Pollution Control Committees perform state or Union Territory implementation functions, including applicable consent, inspection and enforcement tasks under the governing law. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:**

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Map India's environmental institutions by legal basis, scale and function. Answer in about...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate coordination and accountability across policy, science, regulation, enforcement and adjudication. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Coordination chain. **Named evidence/example:** Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee.
- Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard.
- Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision.
- The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes.

- A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis.
- Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage.
- Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Coordination chain. **Named evidence/example:** Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate coordination and accountability across policy, science, regulation, enforcement and...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Coordination chain. **Named evidence/example:** Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** Connect

the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Standards-consent boundary. **Named evidence/example:** National standard-setting and coordination by CPCB are distinct from project-specific consent and local enforcement by the relevant State Board or Committee. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Central-state jurisdiction boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Pollution governance distributes functions across central and state institutions; a central standard does not erase state implementation, and state consent does not create a national standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Evidence-decision chain. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific surveys, monitoring and expert studies are inputs; the competent legal authority retains responsibility for the formal regulatory, administrative or judicial decision. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NGT adjudication boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The National Green Tribunal adjudicates matters within its statutory jurisdiction; it does not replace the ministry, pollution boards, biodiversity authorities or research institutes. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Constituted-delegated boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A body created by statute, an authority constituted under a parent Act, a delegated administrative arrangement and a research society must be identified by their actual legal basis. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Coordination chain. **Named evidence/example:** Effective environmental governance links policy, science, standards, consent, monitoring, enforcement and adjudication while preserving the competent actor at every stage. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory

scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Current evidence boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Institutional mandates, powers, jurisdiction, budgets, staffing, directions and current reforms require dated Acts, rules, notifications, annual reports or official institutional pages. **Analysis:** This identifies the environmental mechanism, system boundary, measured parameter, responsible actor and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecological or regulatory scale, temporal stage, rule vintage, legal status, metric and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate coordination and accountability across policy, science, regulation, enforcement and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.